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SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT AND DRESSING

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a portable, field, steam jacketed, horizontal pressure sterilizer suitable for Field Hospitals.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

DD-B-592	Bottle Sterile Fluid Storage.
QQ-A-200/8	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, Shapes, and Tube, Extruded, 6061
QQ-A-200/9	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, Shapes, and Tube, Extruded, 6063.
QQ-A-250/8	Aluminum Alloy, 5052, Plate and Sheet.
QQ-A-601	Aluminum-Alloy Sand Castings.
QQ-P-416	Plating Cadmium (Electrodeposited).

FSC 6530

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TT-E-529	Enamel, Alkyd, Semi-Gloss.
WW-V-51	Valve, Bronze, Angle, Check and Globe, 125 and 150 Pound, Screwed and Flanged (For Land Use).
ZZ-R-765	Rubber, Silcone: Low-and High-Temperature and Tear Resistant.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-1055	Barrier Material, Waterproofed, Flexible.

Military

MIL-B-40098	Burner Unit, Gasoline, Field Range Outfit, M2.
MIL-C-3133	Cellular Elastomeric Materials, Fabricated Parts.
MIL-F-14072	Finishes For Ground Signal Equipment.
MIL-I-631	Insulation, Electrical, Synthetic-Resin Composition, Nonrigid.
MIL-Q-9858	Quality Program Requirements.
MIL-R-3065	Rubber, Fabricated Parts.
MIL-S-7998	Sandwich Construction Core Material, Balsa Wood.
MIL-S-17917	Sandwich Construction, Aluminum Alloy Facings, Balsa Wood Core
MIL-U-10048	Unit, Fire, Simplified, Converted Type (For Range, Field, M-1937).
MIL-W-6858	Welding, Resistance, Aluminum, Magnesium, Non-Hardening Steels or Alloys, Nickel Alloys, Heat-Resisting Alloys, and Titanium Alloys, Spot and Seam.
MIL-W-8604	Welding of Aluminum Alloys, Process For

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-595	Colors
FED-STD-66	Steel, Chemical Composition and Hardenability.

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Military

MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.
MS-STD-20001	Hinge, Structural, Extruded (ASG).
MS-STD-20257	Hinge, Continuous (ASG).

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

DRAWINGS

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

26000	Sterilizer Assembly, Electric and Gasoline Powered, Lightweight Field.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING MATERIALS

ASTM Designation B145-63	Specification for Leaded Red Brass and Leaded Semi-Red Brass Sand Castings.
ASTM Designation B209-67	Specification for Aluminum-Alloy Sheet and Plate.
ASTM Designation B210-67	Specification for Aluminum Tube, Drawn, Seamless.
ASTM Designation B247-67	Specification for Aluminum-Alloy Die Forgings.
ASTM Designation B408-65	Nickel-Iron Chromium Alloy Rod and Bar.

(Copies of ASTM Standards may be obtained upon application to the American Society for Testing Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.)

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NATIONAL FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION

NFPA No. 70 National Electrical Code

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Fire Protection Association, 60 Batterymarch Street, Boston, Massachusetts.)

U. S. PHARMACOPOEIAL CONVENTION, INCORPORATED

Pharmacopoeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pennsylvania)

AMERICAN SOCIETY OF MECHANICAL ENGINEERS (ASME)

ASME Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society of Mechanical Engineers, United Engineering Center, 345 East 47th St., New York, N. Y. 10017.).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and casualty hazards. Switches, attachment plugs receptacles and other components handled by the user shall be mounted securely. Terminals solely for connection of equipment-grounding conductors shall be in accordance with the National Electric Code, National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) pamphlet No. 70. Wiring terminals shall be provided with appropriate soldering lugs or pressure terminal connectors securely fastened in place and shall be prevented from turning. Minimum conductor wire size shall be No. 14 AWG for branch circuits. Power cords shall be types SJ and SJT. Type HSJ or HSJO cords shall be used where temperatures higher than 250° F. are attained on any surface that the cord can touch. Strain relief shall be provided on the power cord so that the cord shall be capable of withstanding, for one minute without displacement, a pull of 35 pounds, with the connections within the sterilizer disconnected.

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Other than terminal rods and terminal plates, unplated iron or steel shall not be used for the current carrying parts of the sterilizer. Internal wiring shall be routed away from sharp edges, screw threads and other abrading conditions. Switches and other control devices shall have ratings not less than that of the load controlled. The current-carrying capacity of a switch which controls an inductive load, such as a transformer, shall be not less than twice the rated full-load current of the transformer.

3.1.1 The sterilizer chamber shall be certified by the National Board of Boiler and Pressure-Vessel Inspectors and marked in accordance with the appropriate symbol (H,M,S or U) of the American Society of Mechanical Engineers (ASME) for a working pressure of no less than five times the pressure setting of the pressure-relief device provided as part of the assembly. The pressure-relief device shall be connected as close as possible to the system that it is intended to protect and installed so that it is readily accessible for inspection and repair.

3.1.2 Compliance with the above requirements regarding fire and casualty shall not absolve the contractor from complete compliance with the requirements of this specification in order to secure the acceptance of his commodity.

3.2 Materials. Materials shall be as specified hereinafter. All materials employed in construction of the sterilizer assembly shall be impervious to damage from fungi. Materials welded, connected or bolted together shall be those which do not cause electrolysis. Corrosion-resisting steel shall conform to FED-STD-66 for class 301, 302 or 303 unless otherwise specified. Aluminum-alloy sheet and plate material shall conform to ASTM Specification B209-67, Alloy 5052 or 6061; forgings, shall conform to ASTM Specification B247-67, Alloy 6061. Panel faces shall be aluminum conforming to ASTM B209-67, alloy 5052 temper H32. Aluminum piping and tubing shall be as specified in ASTM Specification B210-67; fittings shall be corrosion-resisting steel. Brass castings shall conform to ASTM Specification B145-63, 524A. Aluminum castings shall conform to Specification QQ-A-601 for alloy 108, temper F, unless otherwise specified.

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3.3 Construction. The sterilizer shall operate on the vacuum-pressure, gravity air removal principle and shall be suitable for processing medical and surgical supplies using steam as the sterilizing agent. The sterilizer shall be manually operable from an integral steam generator powered interchangeably by electricity, or a gasoline burner or on steam pressure from an independent source. Each assembled unit shall consist of the following: a chamber assembly, door assembly, manual master control with instrumentation, water supply system, power system, component operating systems, integral housing, other appurtenances and replacement parts. Details of construction shall conform to DPSC drawing 26000 and the requirements of this specification. Maximum overall dimensions of the sterilizer assembly, when closed for shipping, shall not exceed 46 inches long by 24-1/2 inches wide by 37-1/2 inches high.

3.3.1 Chamber assembly. This assembly shall comprise inner and outer shells, a backhead, a door frame, shelf rack and shelves. Inside chamber dimensions shall be not less than 16 inches in diameter by 36 inches in length.

3.3.1.1 Inner and outer shells. Each shell shall be rolled sheet of aluminum alloy welded at the seam; shall withstand operating pressure of 33 pounds per square inch gauge (p.s.i.g.). There shall be no permanent set or deflection when the sterilizer is subjected to the hydrostatic test specified in 4.4.2. The two shells shall be placed one within the other, evenly staged and reinforced to form a jacket over the entire exterior of the inner shell. The lower half of this jacket shall hold enough water, with one filling, to generate steam pressure for at least two complete sterilizing cycles when tested as specified in 4.4.8.1.2. A valve, conforming to WW-V-51 class A, type II, shall be provided to drain water from the jacket. A deflector plate, at the point where the steam enters the chanber, shall be provided.

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3.3.1.2 Backhead. This shall consist of an aluminum sheet, dished outward in approximately the center, to seal the rear of the inner and outer shells. The surrounding flat surfaces shall serve as a back plate to support the sterilizer body and other appurtenances. The plate shall be welded to the inner and outer shells. The dished area shall withstand the pressure specified in 3.3.1.1. A flanged opening shall be provided beneath the dished area through which to insert the electric heaters (3.3.5.1.1) and to facilitate removal of scale and other debris from the bottom of the steam jacket. A scraper as shown on the drawing shall be included for this purpose. The opening flange shall have a "T" fitting for connecting the drain line and the water level indicator to the steam jacket. The flange shall also have a threaded opening, with plug, to receive the direct steam assembly specified in 3.3.5.3.

3.3.1.3 Door frame. The unequal leg channel door frame shall be aluminum alloy, forged or extruded. It shall be continuously welded to the inner and outer shells and intermittently welded to a front plate which in turn shall support the sterilizer body and instrument panel (3.3.3.2.1). the door frame shall support the door; seal the steam jacket; present a smooth surface on the longer leg of the channel for door gasket contact; and engage and conceal the ends of the door-holding arms on tightening.

3.3.1.4 Shelf rack and shelves.

3.3.1.4.1 Shelf rack. The rack shall consist of front and rear bands joined by three pairs of shelf supports welded in place. The bands shall be aluminum extrusions; the shelf supports shall be aluminum alloy sheet. Each support shall be so notched as to held the shelves. The rack shall be easily removed from the chamber.

3.3.1.4.2 Shelves. A bottom shelf, two top shelves, two intermediate upper shelves and two intermediate lower shelves shall be furnished. Each shelf shall be made of perforated aluminum alloy sheet. The bottom shelf shall extend the full length of the chamber; each of the remaining shelves approximately half the length of the chamber.

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3.3.2 Door assembly. The door assembly shall consist of a door and an opening and closing mechanism.

3.3.2.1 Door. The door shall be manually operable and made of aluminum plate. The inside of the door shall contain an accurately machined gasket groove, with gasket. The gasket material shall conform to class IIb, Grade 70 of ZZ-R-765.

3.3.2.2 Opening and closing mechanism. The door shall be attached to the door frame by an extruded aluminum hinge. The hinge shall be on the left side of the chamber when facing the control end. The door shall be adjustable and allow articulation for accurate gasket alignment and easy opening and closing. The door shall be held shut by six radial holding arms without shims, which will cause the door to exert even pressure on the gasket to prevent steam leaks. The holding arms shall be made of aluminum alloy bar stock. The arms shall be fitted to a combination cast aluminum retraction hub and handwheel assembly which shall turn on bearings. A central handle, riding on a corrosion-resisting steel post extending through the door, when turned counterclockwise, shall actuate the handwheel assembly to loosen the holding arms, but not disengage them from the door frame channel; turning the handle clockwise shall tighten the arms against the channel to effect positive door seal. The retraction hub shall include a throw arm which must be actuated by the operator before the holding arms can be removed from the channel. Counterclockwise movement of the throw arm (and consequent travel of the holding arms) shall be limited by an AISI class 316, corrosion-resisting steel stop pin; clockwise movement shall position the ends of the holding arms within the channel preparatory to their being tightened. This arrangement shall allow the operator to release any residual chamber pressure gradually before disengaging the holding arms from the door frame, and thus prevent a sudden outrush of scalding steam from the chamber. The door swing shall allow unobstructed access to full chamber opening.

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3.3.3 Manual master control and instrumentation.

3.3.3.1 Manual master control. Each phase of the sterilizing cycle,i.e. admission of steam to the chamber; exhaust of steam from the chamber as required for wrapped goods, unwrapped goods and liquids; vacuum drying shall be started manually by a programming wheel operating a single multiport valve. The multiport valve shall have a cast brass body, cast bronze stem and a graphite seat. It shall be possible to replace the graphite seat through the vent door (3.3.7.1) at the top of the sterilizer assembly. The programming wheel shall have a cycle phase indicator.

3.3.3.2 Instrumentation. The following instruments shall be provided:

(a) A steam jacket pressure gauge graduated in 1-psig increments over the range of 0 to 60 psig. It shall be accurate within 1-1/2 psig over the entire range when tested as specified in 4.4.7.7.

(b) A combination vacuum-pressure gauge for the chamber. The gauge shall be graduated in 1-pound increments of pressure over the range of 0 to 60 psig and shall also show vacuums of 10, 20, and 30 inches of mercury. It shall be accurate to ≠ 1-1/2 psig over the entire pressure range when tested as specified in 4.4.7.8.

(c) A mechanical cycle timer adjustable for any interval between 0 and 60 minutes. It shall be graduated in 1-minute intervals and include a device that will emit an audible signal upon completion of the timed interval. When tested in accordance with 4.4.7.2, the timer shall be accurate within ≠ 5 seconds between 1 and 15 minutes; ≠ 2, - 0 minutes between 15 and 60 minutes.

(d) A dial-type indicating thermometer graduated in 1-degree F. increments over the range of 50 to 300 degrees F. It shall be accurate within ≠ 1° F. between 210° and 270° F. when tested as specified in 4.4.7.1.

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3.3.3.2.1 Mounting of instruments. The steam pressure gauges and cycle programming wheel shall be in a panel above the door frame. The panel shall also have durably imprinted operating precautions and typical sterilizing exposure periods. The timer shall be installed beneath the door frame so as not to obstruct easy access to pipes and fittings. The temperature-sensing bulb of the thermometer shall be in the chamber drain line (3.3.6.2) and the thermometer dial shall be not more than 4 inches beneath the sterilizing chamber, in an easy-to-read position.

3.3.4 Water supply system. The water supply system consisting of filling funnel, water level indicator, pipes and fittings shall be such that the entire system can be drained by opening one easily accessible handvalve. The steam jacket shall be of sufficient capacity for at least two complete sterilization cycles, including drying time, with one filling of water.

3.3.4.1 Filling funnel. The funnel at the rear of the assembly for filling the steam jacket with water, shall be aluminum alloy sheet. The throat of the funnel shall have a threaded opening to receive a corrosion-resisting steel threaded plug, with stem and handle, to seal the funnel steamtight. The plug shall withstand the pressure specified in 3.3.1.1; shall be easily seated or removed without tools; and shall be secured to the back plate (3.3.1.2) by a chain. The threaded end of the plug assembly shall be hollow and contain a 3/32-inch orifice through one wall. Unscrewing the plug assembly, while there is steam pressure in the enclosure, will cause a small quantity of steam to escape through the orifice and thereby warn the operator that a pressure condition exists. In addition, a metal plate, carrying precautions to be observed by the operator to prevent his being scalded when removing the plug, shall be affixed to the back plate (adjacent to the funnel).

3.3.4.2 Water level indicator. The gauge glass at the rear of the assembly shall be resiliently supported and protected from breakage by a cast aluminum housing welded to the back plate (3.3.1.2). The housing shall have embossed markings to show when the steam enclosure contains 1/4, 1/2, 3/4 and all the water it is specified to hold (3.3.1.1).

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3.3.5 Power system. The power system shall permit interchangeable employment of an electric power unit or liquid gasoline burner to generate steam in the steam enclosure. If ordered, a direct steam assembly (3.3.5.3) shall be included to provide a third power unit, utilizing steam under pressure from an independent source delivered at 50 to 80 psig. It shall not be necessary to remove or disconnect one power unit in order to employ another. Testing the assembly with the gasoline burner, as specified in 4.4.8.1.1, shall cause no damage to the electric power unit.

3.3.5.1 Electric power unit. The electric power unit shall comprise heater assembly, low-water cutoff and associated components. Construction shall be as shown on the drawing.

3.3.5.1.1 Heaters. The three heaters shall be installed steam-tight in the steam enclosure through the opening in the backhead specified in 3.3.1.2. The heaters shall be nickel-chromium resistance wire embedded in magnesium oxide and sheathed in material conforming to ASTM Specification B408-65. The heaters with controls shall be easy to mount and remove. All parts contacting the heaters shall conform to the requirement of 3.2. The heater assembly shall be rated at 9 kilowatts (kw) for operation on 50 - or 60 - cycle electric power as follows:

Volts	Phase	Watts
220	Single	9000
440	Single	6000
208	Three	8500
220,380	Three	9000
440	Three	6000

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The heaters shall be controlled by a single toggle switch. A pilot light shall glow when the heaters are energized. When the switch in "ON" the heaters shall, as required throughout the processing cycle, maintain any steam pressure in the sterilizing chamber within the range of 4 to 30 psig by adjusting a pressure regulator. The pressure regulator shall be accurate within ≠ 2 pounds psig over its entire operating range when tested as specified in 4.4.7.4.

3.3.5.1.2 Low-water cutoff. A manual-reset type low-water cutoff shall cut the flow of electric power to the heaters should water in the steam enclosure fall to an unsafe level. When the cutoff has operated, it shall not revert to the "ON" position when tested as specified in 4.4.7.5.

3.3.5.1.3 Associated components. The heater terminal block shall be at the rear of the sterilizer in an aluminum housing. A second aluminum housing with single opening for conduit connection, also mounted at the rear of the sterilizer assembly, shall contain the main power switch, heater contactors, pressure regulator, terminal block for external electrical connections, ground terminal and pilot light. The front cover of the housing containing the pressure regulator shall display operating directions and have openings through which the pilot lamp, master switch and operating knob for the pressure regulator will extend A metal plate, containing wiring diagrams, shall be affixed to inside door/stand assembly below the control box.

3.3.5.1.4 Dielectric. The sterilizer assembly shall withstand, for one minute, a dielectric test voltage of twice the maximum voltage of 440 volts plus 1000 volts when tested as specified in 4.4.6.

3.3.5.2 Gasoline power unit. This unit shall comprise a firebox, a flue gas exhaust system and a liquid gaoline burner.

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3.3.5.2.1 Firebox. The firebox (Drawing 26000, sheet 6) shall be sized to receive the gasoline burner in such a manner that its flame will be directed toward the bottom of the steam jacket to heat the water and generate the required steam pressures. It shall not be necessary to remove the burner from the firebox in order to close the integral housing. The firebox shall be so designed that the burner can be introduced, operated and serviced from either side of the sterilizer assembly as desired. Two channel slides, each formed from aluminum sheet shall be provided on the inside of the firebox to support the burner. The channels shall be shaped and positioned to permit interchangeable employment of the two burners specified in 3.3.5.2.3. The sides of the firebox shall be aluminum alloy sheet, perforated to provide draft. A "V"-shaped flame baffle assembly shall be provided within the firebox. The assembly shall consist of a baffle with a support plate (welded intermittently to each end) and two removable support rods. The assembly shall be removable and positioned directly beneath the lowest portion of the outer shell. The baffle shall be made of AISI class 430 perforated corrosion-resisting steel. The support plates and rods shall be corrosion-resisting steel. The top of each opening to the firebox shall have a movable, corrosion-resisting steel draft deflector plate which shall extend the full width of the opening and drop into position when the door (3.3.7.3.2) is opened.

3.3.5.2.2 Flue gas exhaust system. A flue gas deflector, with stack assembly, shall cover the length of the outer shell and extend downward on both sides to the top of the firebox. The deflector shall be aluminum sheet with an aluminum band at each end. Each band shall be welded intermittently to its adjacent front or back panel and shall be attached to the support legs at the top of the firebox. The deflector shall contain an opening at approximately the top center to which the stack assembly shall be attached. The stack assembly shall comprise a retainer with two beaded and fluted stacks, each designed to receive a 4-inch diameter common stovepipe. The exterior of the deflector shall be covered with glass fiber insulating material not-less than 3/4 inch thick. The insulating material shall be held in place by a continuous cover of aluminum wire mesh. The wire mesh shall be secured with corrosion-resisting steel staples and screws.

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3.3.5.2.3 Gasoline burner. One gasoline burner conforming to either MIL-B-40098 or MIL-U-10048 shall be furnished by the Government to the contractor for inclusion with each sterilizer assembly. Each gasoline burner shall be charged with gasoline and operated(for a period of at least 5 minutes) in strict accordance with burner manufacturer's instructions. At the conclusion of the testing prior to shipment with the sterilizer, each gasoline burner shall be emptied of gasoline and the tank and piping completely emptied of all gasoline by blowing dry with compressed air. Defective units shall be segregated and timely notice given to the Contracting Officer as to need for additional GFM burners. The following gasoline burner repair parts also GFM shall accompany each sterilizer:

4320-852-9036	Pump, Inflating	1 each
5120-379-2490	Cleaner, Burner Slot	1 each
7310-999-2474	Gland, Packing Valve Stem	2 each
7310-999-2477	Packing, Valve Stem	2 each
7310-999-2547	Plug, Drain, Fuel Tank	2 each
7310-999-2479	Stem, Flame Valve	2 each
7310-999-2483	Washer, Drain Plug	3 each
7310-999-2561	Gasket, Filler Cap	2 each

3.3.5.3 Direct steam assembly. When specified (see 6.2) the direct steam assembly (Drawing 26000, Sheet 8)shall consist of pipes and fittings, a handvalve shutoff, an automatic pressure regulator and a trap. Fitting the parts together and connecting the assembly to the plugged opening specified in 3.3.1.2 shall not require any machining, threading, welding or drilling operations.

3.3.5.3.1 Pipes and fittings. Pipes and fittings shall be nonferrous metal.

3.3.5.3.2 Handvalve shutoff. Valve shall be bronze with renewable nickel-copper alloy seat and Viton disc or equivalent high-quality functional parts. Valve shall withstand a 350-pound hydrostatic test and be leakproof when tested at 150 psig air pressure with valve body submerged in water. It shall be possible to repack the upper seat on the stem with valve fully open. Valve shall have a low-heat-conducting, nonloosening handle (easily removable and replaceable) rigidly secured to the

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valve stem. Durable letters with indicative coloring on the face of the handle shall show the purpose of the valve. The valve shall open when the handle is turned counterclockwise.

3.3.5.3.3 Pressure regulator. The body shall be bronze with union connection on one end, complete with spud and nut. Valve shall be for operation on maximum steam pressure of 80 psig. The secondary pressure shall be controlled by a phosphor bronze spring-loaded bellows. The valve shall be the packless type with phosphor bronze bellows and brass bonnet enclosing a brass stem with nickel-copper alloy disc attached. The valve control assembly shall be enclosed by a metal cover. Other parts of the valve in contact with steam shall be brass, bronze or nickel-copper alloy. A secondary adjustment screw shall be provided to obtain pressures in the steam jacket (of the sterilizing chamber) within the range of 4 to 30 psig. After the selected operating pressure is achieved, it shall be maintained automatically as required during the processing cycles. The valve extension stem shall have adjustable locknuts to restrict adjustment at the valve to any preset low and high pressure within the operating range. The pressure regulator shall be accurate within $\pm$ 1 psig over its entire operating range when tested as specified in 4.4.7.6.

3.3.5.3.4 Trap. The trap shall be pressure-balanced, for operation at 60 psig. It shall discharge condensate and air during the heating and sterilizing periods; shall close against steam; shall be compensated for pressure and temperature; and shall have renewable element, seat and gasket.

3.3.6 Component operating systems. These shall include steam exhaust, chamber drain and drying systems.

3.3.6.1 Steam exhaust system. Steam shall be exhausted from the sterilizing chamber through an aluminum tube which shall terminate at the top rear of the sterilizer assembly. That portion of the tube extending through the back plate shall be bent upward approximately 90 degrees from horizontal and be suitable to receive a hose or tube by which to confine and conduct steam from the assembly.

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3.3.6.2 Chamber drain system. The bottom front of the sterilizing chamber shall have a threaded opening fitted with a corrosion-resistant screened plug through which condensate will drain and air will be expelled during the processing cycles. The plug shall be removable without tools. An aluminum drain line (with thermostatic trap and check valve) shall extend from the chamber opening to a threaded flanged opening at the bottom of the integral housing. The chamber thermostatic trap shall meet the requirements of 3.3.5.3.4.

3.3.6.3 Drying system. This system shall consist of a steam ejector in the multiport valve, which will create reduced chamber pressure, and a filter through which air is admitted to the chamber. The circulating filtered air will entrain and exhaust odors and vapors from the chamber following the sterilization cycle. The filter shall consist of a cast brass column containing tightly packed nickel-copper alloy wool, a flow check and a condensate drip tray. The system shall operate through the master control and allow the sterilizer load to dry with the sterilizing chamber door tightened.

3.3.7 Integral housing. All components of the sterilizing unit shall be contained in a housing which shall consist essentially of a top, bottom and two side panels with a door-stand assembly at each end. The assembled sterilizer unit shall be secured to the housing by corrosion-resisting steel screws countersunk in corrosion-resisting steel grommets. The top, bottom, side and door/stand panels shall be made of materials conforming to MIL-S-7998 and MIL-S-17917. The panels shall be joined and reinforced by aluminum edge castings (tenzaloy, temper F) and extrusions bonded to the panels with a suitable epoxy mixture and held with drive pin rivets during bonding operation. The extrusions shall conform to QQ-A-200/9 for T5. Hardware, fasteners and fittings attached to the panels shall not project beyond the edge castings. When closed, housing shall serve as a shipping container and shall not exceed 25 cubic feet. It shall be suitably shaped for easy handling and stacking, and weight shall not exceed 250 pounds including the weight of the heat source.

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3.3.7.1 Top panel. An opening, approximately 10 inches by 20 inches, shall be provided in the top panel for access to the stack assembly (3.3.5.2.2). The opening shall have a hinged cover provided with a cadmium-plated steel support arm which will hold the cover open 110 degrees above horizontal. The cover shall be aluminum sheet material conforming to QQ-A-250/8 for temper H32. Aluminum angle extrusions, conforming to the requirement of 3.3.7, shall be so placed around the opening as to provide a rabbet into which the cover will close below the surface of the panel. The hinge shall be riveted to the panel and spotwelded to the cover. The hinge shall be aluminum and conform to the requirements of MS-STD-20257. The cover shall close aginst a three-piece gasket, conforming to MIL-C-3133 for type S. The cover shall be held shut as shown on the drawing.

3.3.7.2 Bottom panel. A threaded sleeve, with plug removable (without tools) from inside the enclosure, shall extend through the center of the bottom panel for draining possible water accumulation. The sleeve and plug shall be corrosion-resisting steel, installed flush with the outside of the panel. In addition, openings shall be provided to receive the distal end of the steam jacket (3.3.4) and chamber drain (3.3.6.2) pipes.

3.3.7.3 Side panels. Each side panel shall have two handle assemblies and a firebox opening with hinged door.

3.3.7.3.1 Handle assembly. Each handle assembly shall comprise a spring-loaded handle (with grip) recessed in and riveted to a flanged dish. The dish shall be inserted in a gasketed opening in the panel; the flange shall be riveted approximately flush with the panel. The rivets and all parts of the handle assembly, except the grip, shall be cadmium-plated steel in accordance with QQ-P-416; the grip shall be black plastic conforming to MIL-I-631 for type F, form U, grade a, class I.

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3.3.7.3.2 Firebox door. An opening, 14 inches high by 19-1/2 inches long, shall be provided in each side panel for inserting the gasoline burner (3.3.5.2.3). Each opening shall have a door hinged on the bottom edge. The door, including hinge and fasteners, and the panel rabbeting shall be the same as specified in 3.3.7.1 with the following exceptions: An aluminum alloy spacer (to stabilize the burner during handling and transit) shall be riveted to the inside of the door close to the bottom edge; and a chain assembly shall be provided in lieu of a support arm. The chain assembly shall permit the door to be held open at approximately 1/2 inch intervals, with chain length restricted so that door opening will not exceed 30 degrees from the closed position. When the chain is released, the door shall drop to the vertical position.

3.3.7.4 Door/stand assembly. The door/stand assemblies shall be hinged at the bottom so that when closed they will seal the ends of the housing, and, when fully opened, will support the sterilizer in proper operating position. Each door/stand assembly shall open against a knot-free, maple wood block, 1/2 inch wide by 20 inches long by 13/32 inch thick, riveted to the enclosure bottom panel. The inside of each assembly shall have four hat sections riveted to the panel to stabilize the contents of the enclosure during handling and transit. Each hat section shall be topped with material, conforming to MIL-C-3133 for type S, to prevent marring the sterilizer unit. Two spring-loaded wing or "T" Bar screws shall also be provided on the inside of each door/stand assembly to secure it while fully open. The "T" Bar screws shall be corrosion-resisting steel and shall be attached to a threaded stud extending through the panel into an aluminum alloy backing plate. The backing plate shall be riveted flush with the front of the panel. The hinge shall be extruded aluminum, continuous, and shall conform to the requirements of MS-STD-20001. Each door/stand assembly shall have a tubular, recessed gasket and shall be held shut by six clamp assemblies. The gasket material shall conform to MIL-R-3065. Each clamp assembly shall comprise a clamping mechanism recessed in and spotwelded to a flanged dish. The dish shall be inserted in an opening in the top or side panel; the flange shall be riveted flush with the panel. The spring-steel hook on the clamping mechanism shall engage a strike riveted to the door panel.

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Instruction plates shall be provided on the inside and outside of the door panel in conspicuous locations to be read when setting up and closing the assembly.

3.3.7.5 Temperature resistance. When tested as specified in 4.4.8.6, the temperature of the exterior of the integral enclosure shall not exceed 180° F.

3.3.8 Other appurtenances.

3.3.8.1 Safety and relief valves. An "L"-shaped pipe assembly, with the shorter leg of the "L" terminating in the steam jacket, shall extend through the back plate and contain a safety valve and a pressure relief valve with handvalve control.

3.3.8.1.1 Safety valve. The safety valve meeting ASME standards shall be set at the specified operating pressure of the vessel. Valve shall be so sealed that the setting cannot be altered, shall blow down at least two psig before closing and shall be so sized that pressure in the vessel will not rise more than ten percent over the set pressure.

3.3.8.1.2 Relief valve. This valve shall be so installed in the pipe assembly that steam will pass the safety valve and permit pressure in the steam enclosure to reach 22 psig maximum. A handvalve shall be provided at the end of the pipe assembly to permit optional use of the relief valve when the gasoline burner is employed.

3.3.8.2 Baffle plate. A perforated aluminum baffle plate shall cover the opening through which steam is admitted to the sterilizing chamber.

3.3.8.3 Drain. A simple means of draining the unit completely, as protection against damage from freezing, shall be provided.

3.3.9 Replacement parts. The following parts, in the quantities indicated, shall be provided with each sterilizer assembly:

Description	Quantity
Gasket, door	1
Washer (for funnel plug)	2

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Description	Quantity
Parts for electric heaters:	1
Element, heating, 220 V., 3000 W.	3
Sleeve, heating element	6
Gasket, heating element, mounting plate	2

3.4 Performance.

3.4.1 Temperature and pressure come-up. When tested in accordance with 4.4.8.1, each sterilizer assembly shall achieve pressure in the steam jacket and sterilizing chamber as specified in table I.

TABLE I - Steam enclosure pressure and sterilizing chamber temperature come-up times

METHOD OF OPERATION	MAXIMUM TIME (in minutes) TO ACHIEVE PRESSURE IN STEAM JACKET		MAXIMUM TIME (in minutes) TO HEAT THE STERILIZER CHAMBER	
	18 psig	30 psig	250° to 254° F.	270° to 272° F.
On steam under pressure generated by electric heaters.	22	25	27	30
On steam under pressure generated by gasoline burner.	27	32	34	40

3.4.2 Bacteriological function. The sterilizer assembly shall be capable of killing 100 percent of spores on test strips (see 6.5) when the assembly is tested as specified in 4.4.8.2.

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3.4.3 Fast exhaust. The time required to reduce steam pressure in the sterilizing chamber from 30 psig to ambient atmospheric shall not exceed 2 minutes when tested as specified in 4.4.8.3.

3.4.4 Drying system. Immediately upon its removal from the sterilizing chamber, moisture retained by the package, shall not exceed 3 percent of the original weight of the package following the test specified in 4.4.8.4. In addition, the test package shall, following the test sterilizing cycle, be free of scorch. With sterilizer door closed, sterilizer shall be capable of drying a full load to a condition suitable for immediate use or for storage within 10 minutes (15 minutes for fabrics) following sterilization.

3.4.5 Solutions. Exhausting the sterilizing chamber following the test specified in 4.4.8.5 shall be accomplished within 27 minutes; without blowing the bottle stoppers; with average loss of not more than 5 percent of the liquid from the load; and with normal automatic sealing of the bottles.

3.4.6 Operations test, welding The sterilizer shall pass the operations test specified in 4.4.7.9. There shall be no cracks in the welded areas After testing, the units shall be cleaned and touched-up with paint where necessary. Burners shall be securely mounted in sterilizers for shipment.

3.4.7 Ruggedness. The assembly shall, without physical damage or impairment of its operating efficiency, withstand the drop test specified in 4.4.9.

3.5 Finish. Except for the integral housing (3.3.7), all metal components of the sterilizer assembly exposed to view, excluding back of the door, chamber inner walls, rack and shelves, shall have finish P513 in accordance with MIL-F-14072. The final film shall be one coat of paint, 0.001 inch thick, conforming to TT-E-529 for class B. A black, commercial painted finish on gauge, thermometer and timer cases, including bezels, shall conform to the same specification except for color to be 27068 of FED-STD-595. Metal parts of the integral housing shall be as follows, in

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accordance with MIL-F-14072:

(a) Aluminum components shall have finish P513; final film designation C.

(b) Steel components shall have finish P213; final film designation C.

Cadmium plating shall conform to Type II of QQ-P-416. The color of the components finished in accordance with this paragraph shall be X24087 of FED-STD-595.

3.6 Workmanship. The sterilizer assembly shall be new and free of defects and imperfections that might affect the safety, serviceability and appearance of the finished product. All parts shall be free of sharp edges and burrs.

3.7 Service data. The contractor shall furnish, with each unit, two copies of a service data manual. In addition, the contractor shall mail 15 copies of the approved service data to the contracting officer for distribution. This service data shall contain complete instructions for installation, operation, maintenance, and a list of component parts. The information shall specifically include instructions, drawings, and templates for plumbing, power wiring, structural modifications, and special support devices necessary for roughing-in preparations prior to installation of the unit. The service data shall include such detailed information which shall permit ready installation and maintenance of the item. All information contained in the manual shall be suitably indexed to permit ready reference to the required information. Wiring diagrams shall be included for electrical items or components. Wiring diagrams, drawings, and descriptive material shall include adequate information so that the replacement parts can be ordered by the manufacturer's part number, and without confusion as to the item identification. Identical or interchangeable replacement parts shall be identified by a single part number only. As soon as practicable after award of the contract or purchase order, the contractor shall furnish to the contracting officer, via the cognizant Government inspector, two preliminary copies

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of his proposed service data, for review and comment by Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center. The preliminary service data shall be submitted sufficiently early to permit adequate review by the Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center (based on a maximum period of 30 days for such review) and to allow incorporation by the contractor of required revisions and corrections in the final service data without delaying delivery under the contract or purchase order. Should the supplier have furnished acceptable manuals for the identical item within two years preceding the data of contract, and propose to furnish manuals identical with those previously accepted, then the requirements for review of drafts and submission of 15 additional copies may be waived upon request.

3.7.1 Preventive maintenance instructions. The service data shall include the following preventive maintenance instructions in order to prevent possible collapse of the sterilizer chamber:

a. If available, use only distilled water. If this is not possible, use water as pure as practicable, demineralizing and/or filtering, as required, to assure that it is free of mud, sediment, and minerals as far as it is practical.

b. Use care in filling the sterilizer jacket, to prevent overflow of water. When filling, vent air from the jacket by manually actuating the safety valve or by turning the selector valve knob temporarily to the "Sterilize" position, with the chamber door open. Entrance of water into the low water cut-off switch enclosure, at the rear of the sterilizer, can disable this essential protective device. Under no circumstances should the sterilizer be hosed down for cleaning.

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c. Daily, check the low-water cut-off and water gauge (sight glass) for proper functioning, by opening the drain valve and draining the jacket while the heating elements are turned on (indicated by glow of the red pilot light). Caution: The drain valve should be piped to a container, to prevent operator injury from live steam. The low water cut-off should actuate, to turn off the power (extinguishing the pilot light), by the time the jacket is drained. The water gauge should now show empty.

d. Daily, check the pressure control switch in accordance with steps 1-5 of the Preliminary Procedure (Electric Heat) section, Chapter III B of the sterilizer service data manual.

e. Daily, manually actuate the "relieve handle" of each safety valve, with steam pressure in the jacket, to assure that these valves are operable.

Utilizing the foregoing preventive maintenance procedures, the operator can readily determine the serviceability of the sterilizer. If the low water cut-off fails to actuate or the water gauge remains full, when checked as described above, the operator should, if practicable, discontinue use of the unit until a medical equipment repairman is available to restore it to serviceability. Under emergency conditions, an unserviceable unit may be utilized, provided that the operator insures that it contains sufficient water in the jacket at all times.

3.8 Identification marking. Two metal nameplates shall be provided and these shall be fastened to each assembly, as specified below, by rivets or drive screws. Characters shall be white on a background painted flat black or the color specified in 3.5.

3.8.1 Government identification. This nameplate shall be 3-5/8 inches wide by 4 inches long and shall contain the following: type of sterilizer (Sterilizer Assembly, Electric and Gasoline Powered, Light weight, Field); manufacturer's order number; design pressure of the sterilizing chamber; volts; cycles and phase of heaters; Federal Stock Number (if any); manufacturer's name; and U. S. Government contract or order number. The plate shall be affixed to the outside of the backhead.

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3.8.2 Manufacturer's identification. This plate shall be 1-1/2 inches wide by 3-1/2 inches long, legibly and durably imprinted with the following: model number, serial number, voltage, phase, cycles, maximum kilowatts and maximum amperage. The plate shall be affixed to the outside of the backhead.

3.9 Welding. All welds shall be continuous. Welding of aluminum alloys shall be in accordance with MIL-W-8604. Spot welding, where used, shall be in accordance with MIL-W-6858. Welding shall be durable, sound in every detail and in accordance with latest practices recommended by the American Welding Society. Welding shall be performed only by operators experienced in performing the type of weld, and using the materials required by this specification. Prior to engaging in production welding, the welder shall demonstrate satisfactory workmanship by means of tests specified in section 4 and by conformance with the Performance Qualification paragraphs of Section IX, Welding Qualifications, ASME Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code.

3.9.1 Preparation of surfaces. Prior to welding, surfaces shall be free from grease, coatings or other foreign matter which could adversely effect the weld. The ends of cylinders shall be filed or machined smooth. Rough, torn, or sheared edges are not suitable.

3.9.2 Joints. All weld joints shall comply with drawing requirements respecting type, location and dimensions. Where practicable, all weld joints shall flair into the adjoined metal in gradual smooth curves, and be sealed on all sides. Beads shall be smooth and free of slag when fluxes are used. Burn-through and undercut shall not be acceptable. If fluxes are used, the excess shall be removed by a suitable method promptly after welding. There shall be no visible evidence of cracks, voids, porosity or inclusions in the weld, nor evidence of burning or overheating in the base metal. Throughout the cylinders to backhead and door ring areas, the fillet weld head contour shall be flat or slightly convex. Weld beads shall not be concave. There shall be no notches (incomplete fusing) at roots of cylinder welds. Porous welds on chambers shall be unacceptable. The proper gun angle must be maintained during the shell to backhead welding operation. Rotating the part will assist uniformity.

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3.9.3 Weld Test Specimen Failure. Failure of the Weld Test Specimen to comply with 3.3, 4.4.1.2, 4.4.1.3 and 4.4.1.4 shall constitute disqualification of the welding operator for production welding and rejection of all units represented by the weld test specimen.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actually performing the tests.

4.2 Sampling for acceptance inspection.

4.2.1 For weld inspection of sterilizing chamber.

4.2.1.1 Weld Test Specimen. Prior to producing welded sterilizer chamber assemblies, each welding operator shall prepare one Weld Test Specimen for weld inspection and approval.

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Only prior approved operators shall produce welded assemblies. During production of welded assemblies, each operator shall prepare one Weld Test Specimen for each uniform lot of welded assemblies completed. The Weld Test Specimen shall be inspected and approved prior-to-continuing production. Non-approval of the Weld Test Specimen shall constitute Inspection Rejection of the lot of completed assemblies for either reworking or final rejection. The weld test specimen shall consist of three pieces of production material used to fabricate the sterilizing chamber:

(a) one 5" by 8" piece of flat back plate

(b) one 5" by 8" piece of inner shell material, curved to radius of inner shell

(c) one 5" by 8" piece of outer shell material, curved to radius of outer shell.

The inner and outer shell pieces shall be welded along one 8" edge to the flat surface of the piece of back plate, in the same fashion as the shells are welded to the back plate in production. When completed, it shall exactly simulate a section cut from a production sterilizing chamber unit, and shall have received the same cleaning, welding and finishing procedures for this unit.

4.2.2 Sampling for group A examination and test. The chamber assembly of each sterilizer in each lot shall be subjected to the group A examination and test specified in 4.3.1.

4.2.3 Sampling for group B examination and tests. A random sample of sterilizer assemblies shall be selected in accordance with table II from each lot and shall be subjected to each of the group B examinations and tests specified in 4.3.2.

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TABLE II - Sampling for group B examination and tests AQL (approx.) = 1.5 percent defective

Number of sterilizer assemblies in lot	Number of sterilizer assemblies in sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
		Number of sterilizer assemblies nonconforming on any group B examination and test	
15 and under	7	0	1
16 to 40	10	0	1
41 to 110	15	0	1
111 to 300	25	1	2
301 to 500	35	1	2
501 and over	50	2	3

4.2.4 Sampling for group C tests. A random sample of sterilizer assemblies shall be selected from each lot in accordance with table III and shall be subjected to each of the group C tests specified in 4.3.3.

TABLE III - Sampling for group C tests

Number of sterilizer assemblies in lot	Number of sterilizer assemblies in sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
		Number of sterilizer assemblies nonconforming on any group C test	
15 and under	3	0	1
16 to 40	5	0	1
41 to 110	7	0	1
111 to 300	10	0	1
301 and over	15	1	2

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4.2.5 Sampling for group D tests. The first sterilizer assembly in the first lot shall be subjected to the group D tests specified in 4.3.4. The group D tests may be waived upon request to the contracting officer, providing that the manufacturer can produce evidence, including certified test records, that sterilizer assemblies of the same type and design were accepted by the Government under a previous contract.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Group A examination and test. Each chamber assembly (less rack and shelves) shall be subjected to the hydrostatic test specified in 4.4.2 and the results of the test compared with the requirements of this specification. Assemblies failing to pass the test shall be rejected. Those assemblies failing the test because of minor leaks at weld points may be reworked and retested.

4.3.2 Group B examination and tests. Each sterilizer assembly selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be subjected to each of the examinations and tests specified herein and the results of each examination and test compared with the requirements of this specification. Failure to conform to this specification for any group B examination and test shall be counted as a defect and the assembly shall be rejected. If the number of such nonconforming sterilizer assemblies in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Group B examinations and tests	Reference paragraph
Adjustment, fit and materials	4.4.3
Examination of replacement parts	4.4.3.1
Dimensions and weight	4.4.4
Wattage	4.4.5

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4.3.3 Group C test. Each of the sample sterilizer assemblies selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the tests specified herein, and the results compared with the requirements of this specification. Failure to conform to this specification for the group C tests shall be counted as a defect and the assembly shall be rejected. If the number of such nonconforming sterilizer assemblies in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

Group C test	Reference paragraph
Accuracy of components	4.4.7

4.3.4 Group D tests. Each of the sample sterilizer assemblies selected in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to each of the tests specified herein, and the results of each test compared with the requirements of this specification. No sterilizer assembly shall be accepted for delivery until these tests have been satisfactorily completed. Failure of the sterilizer assembly to pass any of the tests shall result in the rejection of all units so manufactured until the cause of rejection has been corrected on all assemblies and the sample has been successfully retested. Sterilizer assemblies of the same type and design need not be retested on subsequent contracts or orders. A certified record of the test results shall therefore be retained by the manufacturer.

Group D tests	Reference paragraph
Performance	4.4.8
Ruggedness	4.4.9

4.4 Examination and tests.

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4.4.1 Apparatus and instruments. Apparatus and instruments employed for the testing shall be the laboratory precision type. They shall be checked carefully to determine that they have been installed durably and accurately. They shall be calibrated properly to assure laboratory accuracy. Performance characteristics shall be timed by a stopwatch; chamber temperatures shall be measured by the dial-type thermometer in the chamber drain line; steam jacket pressures by the steam jacket pressure gauge.

4.4.1.1 Visual inspection. The weld test specimens shall be examined for compliance with all requirements of 3.3 and subparagraphs thereto.

4.4.1.2 Destructive Testing.. Following the visual inspection of 4.4.1.1 the Weld Test Specimen shall be cut into five similar pieces, by making four transverse cuts on the 8" length. Each piece shall have a backplate measuring approximately 1-1/2" x 5" and shall be a miniature replica of the original test specimen. Both of the end pieces shall be discarded. Two of the three center test pieces shall be used for fracture inspections of the inner and outer shell welds; one set of fractures shall be produced by bending the shells away from their fillet welds, and the other set, by bending the shells toward their fillet welds. In each case the moment of bending shall be at the weld areas. If fracture does not occur at a 90 bend of the shell, the sample shall be accepted as passing the test and no further inspection shall be required. Welds which fracture easily or at bending of 90 degrees or less shall be unacceptable.

4.4.1.3 Weld Fracture Inspection. The weld fractures shall be visually inspected, if necessary, under magnification. The fracture shall be free of excessive porosity, discoloration, inclusions and evidences of cracks, laminations, overlapping or undercutting. The weld shall exhibit evidences of adequate fusion with respect to root and also joint penetration.

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4.4.1.4 Microscopic Inspection. The third center piece of Weld Test Specimen from 4.4.1.2 shall have one of its saw-cut surfaces prepared by grinding and polishing methods suitable for microscopic inspection of the welds as seen on cross section. Magnification shall be nominally at 10 diameters. Either Kellers or other suitable etches shall be used to reveal the fusion zone. With reference to suitable depth of weld penetration, 50% to 75% of the backplate shall be considered adequate. The microscopic inspection procedure need be followed only on the preproduction weld test sample unless failure results on the tests identified as Weld Fracture Inspection (4.4.1.3).

4.4.2 Hydrostatic test. The steam jacket, with filling funnel and plug (3.3.4.1) in place, shall be tested with a hydrostatic pressure of 55 pounds per square inch (psig) for 10 minutes during which there shall be no leaking or sweating. The unit shall be examined for permanent set or deflection after the pressure has been released.

4.4.3 Adjustment, fit and materials. The sterilizer assemblies shall be subjected to a thorough examination to ascertain that the materials, workmanship and design are in strict conformance with the requirements of this specification, contract and approved drawings. The fit of parts shall be observed.

4.4.3.1 Examination of replacement parts. All replacement parts shall be examined to determine that they are duplicates of the parts furnished in the sterilizer assemblies. If the inspector has any reason to doubt the ready interchangeability of the repair parts with the original parts, he may require a demonstration of interchangeability. The wattage of the heating elements furnished as replacement parts shall be measured in accordance with the sampling for group B examination and tests.

4.4.4 Dimensions and weight. The sterilizer assemblies without the parts specified in 3.3.5.3 and 3.3.9 shall be measured and weighed to determine whether the chamber and overall dimensions and weight conform to the requirements of this specification and the drawings.

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4.4.5 Wattage. The wattage of the sterilizer assembly at the rated voltages shall be measured to determine conformance with 3.3.5.1.1.

4.4.6 Dielectric strength. Immediately following operation of the sterilizer assembly for one complete sterilizing cycle at 270° F. and with the main electric power switch "OFF", it shall be subjected, for one minute, to a dielectric test voltage of 1880 applied between the first terminal on the terminal block and the body of the sterilizer assembly. The test shall be repeated with the following variations: once with the main electric power switch "ON", once with the power switch "ON" and the test voltage applied between terminal "A" on the magnetic contactor and the body of the sterilizer.

4.4.7 Components.

4.4.7.1 Dial thermometer. This instrument shall be checked aginst certified laboratory standards and accuracy recorded

4.4.7.2 Mechanical timer. The timer shall be tested against a certified stopwatch and accuracy recorded

4.4.7.3 Safety and relief valves. The safety and relief valves shall be connected to a steam source. The report shall include the value at which each valve released the pressure and the value at which it reseated.

4.4.7.4 Pressure regulator component of electric power unit. The pressure regulator shall be tested at intervals of 5, 10, 15, 20 and 30 psig. The accuracy shall be recorded

4.4.7.5 Low-water cutoff. The low-water cutoff shall be tested by operating the assembly (electrically) without water to determine that the cutoff functions properly. After the unit has cut off, the steam enclosure shall be filled with water to the proper level, the reset button actuated and the assembly operated again to ascertain that the electric steam generator still functions properly.

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4.4.7.6 Pressure regulator valve. The automatic steam pressure regulator valve (3.3.5.3.3) shall be connected to a steam source. The accuracy shall be recorded

4.4.7.7 Pressure gauge for steam enclosure. The gauge for measuring pressure in the steam jacket shall be tested for accuracy against a certified laboratory standard gage and the accuracy shall be recorded.

4.4.7.8 Chamber pressure gauge. The pressure gauge for the sterilizing chamber shall be tested for accuracy against a certified laboratory standard gage and the accuracy recorded.

4.4.7.9 Operations test. Two sterilizers shall be taken at random and operated with the gasoline burner for a minimum of 100 cycles with the chamber cooled to room temperature between cycles. The chamber assemblies shall then be removed and inspected for cracks in welded areas. After testing door gaskets shall be replaced, the units reassembled and then retested hydrostatically (see 4.4.2) for leakage.

4.4.8 Performance. The performance tests shall be conducted at ambient pressure of 14.7 $\pm$ 0.1 pounds per square inch absolute (psia). Unless otherwise specified, each test shall be started with the assembly at ambient 50° to 60° F. for the electric heaters and 35° F. for the gasoline burner and the steam jacket containing water (40° to 45° F.) to the "FULL" mark on the water level indicator.

4.4.8.1 Temperature and pressure come-up. Each test shall be conducted in the order specified, with both the electric and the gasoline power units in place.

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4.4.8.1.1 Test on gasoline power. Two separate tests shall be conducted as follows:

First Test

Step 1	Close chamber door tight and turn cycle programming wheel to "OFF".
Step 2	Service and ignite the gasoline burner, per instructions on the burner, and insert it in the firebox.
Step 3	Adjust flame intensity to its maximum.
Step 4	Open steam jacket relief valve.
Step 5	Record the time required for pressure in the steam jacket to reach 18 psig.
Step 6	When pressure in the jacket reaches 18 psig, turn the cycle programming wheel to "STERILIZE" and record time required to reach 250° F. in the sterilizing chamber.
Step 7	Exhaust the chamber and steam jacket to zero gauge pressure, close steam jacket relief valve, extinguish the burner flame and drain the steam jacket.

Second test

Step 1	Repeat Steps 1 through 3, as specified for the first test.
Step 2	Record the time required for pressure in the steam jacket to reach 30 psig.

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Second test (cont'd)

Step 3 When pressure in the steam jacket reaches 30 psig, turn the cycle programming wheel to "STERILIZE" and record the time required to reach 270 F. in the sterilizing chamber.

Step 4 Exhaust the chamber and steam jacket to zero gauge pressure, extinguish the burner flame and drain the steam jacket.

4.4.8.1.2 Tests on electric power. Two separate tests shall be conducted as follows:

First Test

Step 1 Connect the assembly to a 220-volt, 60-cycle, single-phase power supply.

Step 2 Turn master power switch "ON" to energize the heaters.

Step 3 Close chamber door tight and turn cycle programming wheel to "OFF".

Step 4 Turn pressure regulator knob clockwise as far as it will go.

Step 5 Record the time required for pressure in the steam jacket to reach 18 pounds psig. Then turn the pressure regulator knob counterclockwise until the pilot light goes out. Pressure in the steam jacket should stabilize between 15 and 18 psig.

Step 6 When pressure in the steam jacket is stabilized between 15 and 18 psig, turn the cycle programming wheel to "STERILIZE" and record time required to reach 250 F. in the sterilizing chamber.

Step 7 Exhaust the chamber and steam jacket to zero gauge pressure, turn off heaters and drain the steam jacket.

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Second Test

Step 1 Repeat Steps 1 through 4, as specified for the first test.

Step 2 Record the time required for pressure in the steam jacket to reach 30 psig. Then turn the pressure regulator knob counterclockwise until pilot light goes out. Pressure in the steam jacket should stabilize between 26 and 30 pounds psig.

Step 3 When pressure in the steam jacket is stabilized between 26 and 30 psig, turn the cycle programming wheel to "STERILIZE" and record time required to reach 270° F. in the sterilizing chamber.

Step 4 Exhaust the chamber and steam jacket to zero gauge pressure, turn off heaters and drain the steam jacket.

4.4.8.2 Bacteriological function. Two separate tests shall be conducted operating the assembly on either electric or gasoline power.

First Test

Step 1 Sterilization test strips conforming to 3.4.2 shall be used.

Step 2 Place four of the spore test strips on the bottom shelf of the sterilizing chamber (two at the rear and two at the front), placing each set of two strips between two gauze sponges (4" x 4"). Hold remaining two strips for viability controls.

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First Test (cont'd)

Step 3 Close chamber door tight and operate the sterilizer in accordance with the sterilizer manufacturer's instructions. The sterilization time shall be in accordance with the sterilization test strip manufacturer's instructions.

Step 4 With 15 to 18 psig pressure in the steam jacket turn the cycle programming wheel to "STERILIZE".

Step 5 Twelve minutes after temperature in the chamber has reached 250° F., turn the programming wheel to "FAST EXHAUST". When pressure in the chamber is reduced to zero gauge, turn the programming wheel to "OFF". Then open door, remove spore strips in a manner that will preclude contamination and conduct test for sterility as recommended in the U.S. Pharmacopoeia.

Second Test

Step 1 Repeat Steps 1, 2 and 3, as specified for the first test.

Step 2 With 27 to 30 psig in the steam jacket turn the programming wheel to "STERILIZE".

Step 3 Three minutes after temperature in the chamber has reached 270°F., turn the cycle programming wheel to "FAST EXHAUST". When pressure in the chamber is reduced to zero gauge, turn the programming wheel to "OFF". Then open door, remove spore strips in a manner that will preclude contamination and conduct test for sterility as recommended in the U.S. Pharmacopoeia.

4.4.8.3 Fast exhaust. The test shall be conducted with the assembly operating on either electric or gasoline power.

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4.4.8.3.1 Test load. The test load shall be a tray of surgical instruments. The tray (unwrapped) shall contain 100 assorted surgical instruments such as hemostats, retractors and forceps.

4.4.8.3.2 Test procedure.

Step 1 Place test load in the sterilizing chamber.

Step 2 Operate the assembly per the manufacturer's instructions for a 270° F. sterilizing cycle. When the sterilizing chamber reaches 270° F., turn the cycle programming wheel to "FAST EXHAUST" and record the time required to reduce pressure to zero gauge.

4.4.8.4 Drying. The test shall be conducted with the assembly powered by the gasoline burner.

4.4.8.4.1 Test load. The test pack shall contain the following (freshly laundered and loosely packed): 2 double-muslin wrappers, 3 surgical gowns, 12 towels, 30 gauze sponges (4 inches by 4 inches), 5 lap sponges and 1 drape sheet. The pack shall be approximately 12 inches by 12 inches by 20 inches and shall weigh 10 to 12 pounds.

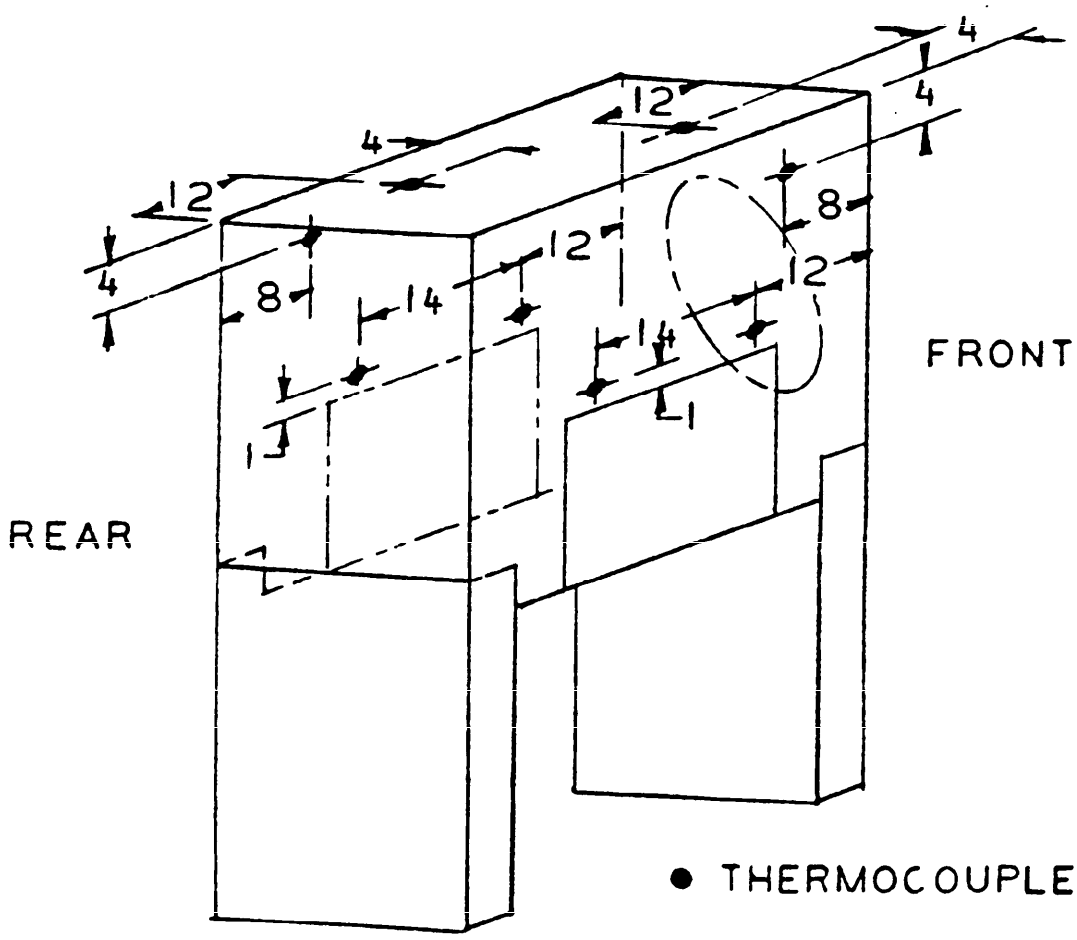
4.4.8.4.2 Test procedure.

Step 1 Place the test pack on its edge in the sterilizing chamber. Close door tight. Operate the assembly (following manufacturer's instructions), exposing the pack to 250°F. for 30 minutes.

Step 2 At completion of the 30-minute exposure period, turn cycle programming wheel to "FAST EXHAUST". When chamber pressure drops to zero, turn programming wheel to "OFF".

Step 3 Within two minutes after turning the programming wheel to "OFF", remove pack from chamber, weigh it at once and record the weight.

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NOTE:
1. ALL DIMENSIONS IN INCHES.

FIGURE 1 - THERMOCOUPLE LOCATIONS

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4.4.8.5 Solution exhaust system. The test shall be conducted with the assembly powered by the gasoline burner.

4.4.8.5.1 Test load. The test load shall be 14 sterile fluid storage bottles, each containing 1000 cc of water (see 6.5).

4.4.8.5.2 Test procedure.

Step 1 Place test load in chamber.

Step 2 Close door tight. Operate assembly per the manufacturer's instructions to expose the load for 30 minutes at 250° F.

Step 3 At end of 30-minute exposure period, turn cycle programming wheel to "SLOW EXHAUST", turn off gaoline burner and record the time required to reduce the chamber pressure to zero psig.

Step 4 Open door only about one-half inch. Wait five minutes; then remove load.

4.4.8.6 Temperature resistance test. The test shall be conducted with the assembly powered by the gasoline burner; with no load in the sterilizing chamber; and without connecting the assembly to any type of venting system. The test shall be started with the sterilizing assembly at ambient 72° to 74° F. The procedure shall be as follows:

Step 1 Apply thermocouples to the outside of the integral housing, see Figure 1, and connect the leads to a recording potentiometer.

Step 2 Service and ignite the gasoline burner, per instructions on the burner, and insert it in the firebox.

Step 3 Begin recording thermocouple temperatures.

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Step 4 Close the steam enclosure relief valve and adjust burner flame intensity to its maximum.

Step 5 Operate the sterilizer assembly, per the manufacturer's instructions, for one complete sterilizing cycle to include: maintenance of 270° F. in the sterilizing chamber for 30 minutes.

Step 6 At the end of the 30-minute "sterilizing" phase of the cycle, turn cycle programming wheel to "SLOW EXHAUST" and extinguish the burner flame. When the chamber pressure is reduced to zero psig, turn off potentiometer and remove the recording chart.

4.4.9 Ruggedness tests. The sterilizer shall be tested with the electric power unit and gasoline burner in operating position.

4.4.9.1 Preparations.

4.4.9.1.1 Sterilizer assembly. Drain water from the assembly; arrange the rack and shelves in their normal operating position within the sterilizing chamber; close chamber door and tighten holding arms snug, without applying undue pressure on the gasket; latch the ends of the integral housing as well as access doors to the firebox and the stack assembly.

4.4.9.1.2 Test site. Select a level ground surface 6 feet square that, when tested with a cone penetrometer, will indicate an average reading of 450 psi minimum. This shall be obtained by averaging the results of ten individual readings, taken 10 inches apart, each indicating at least 250 psi.

4.4.9.2 Test instrument. The cone penetrometer shall be for measuring soil compactness and trafficability. It shall consist of a 30-degree cone having a 1/2-square inch base area, a metal staff, a proving ring, a micrometer or indicating dial

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with a range of 0 to 750 psi, and a handle. As the cone is forced into the ground, the proving ring will deform in proportion to the force applied. The amount of force required to push the cone slowly into the ground in the vertical plane will be indicated in psi on the dial inside the ring. The instrument employed for the test shall be as approved by the contracting officer.

4.4.9.3 Test procedure. Place the sterilizer assembly in a rope sling in the center of the test site. Hoist the sterilizer assembly so as to place its bottom surface 51 inches above and parallel with the ground. Release the assembly from the sling by a single axe blow, so as not to disturb horizontal alignment, allowing it to fall free the entire 51 inches. Repeat this procedure with first one side of the assembly and then with one end of the assembly 51 inches above and parallel with the ground. Following the three drop tests, the sterilizer must pass each of the tests specified in 4.4.8.1 and 4.4.8.4.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One (1) sterilizer assembly, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Replacement parts and direct steam assembly. Each part (3.3.9) shall be sealed in an individual moistureproof bag. The outside of each bag shall be legibly and durably inscribed with a description of its content and the identity of the applicable major assembly for which the part is intended. The bags shall then be placed in a carton. A waterproof envelope, containing a list of all the enclosed parts, shall be securely affixed to the outside of the carton. The carton shall be placed in the sterilizing chamber. The direct steam assembly, if called for in the contract or order, shall be packaged in a separate protective carton that will withstand the test specified in 4.4.9. The outside of the carton shall be legibly and durably inscribed with a description of the contents and this carton shall also be placed in the sterilizing chamber.

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5.1.3 Level A. The shelves and all exterior surfaces of the assembly shall be protected by wrapping with kraft paper and cushioning with flexible corrugated fiberboard or other suitable materials. Wrapping and cushioning material shall be secured by cotton cord or tape, or kraft gummed-paper tape. Work shall be such as to prevent marring, scratching, or damage to the unit. The rack and shelves (wrapped and cushioned) shall be placed in the sterilizing chamber and shall be sufficiently cushioned to prevent shifting or damage. The door on each unit shall be closed and the holding arms tightened without undue pressure (only enough to allow the front end of the integral housing to be closed) to avoid excessive door gasket compression.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or level C, as specified.

5.2.1 Level A. Each unit shall be overpacked in an exterior container designed for type 3 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, overseas type, or PPP-B-621, class 2. The unit shall be adequately secured within the exterior container by bolts, wood braces, or other interior fittings, to insure against shifting, breakage, marring, or denting of surfaces. Adequate cushioning material shall be used between all bracing and the unit. All box panels, except base, shall be lined with waterproof barrier material conforming to the requirements of PPP-B-1055, class L-2 (b) in such a manner as to prevent direct entry of water. As an alternate, each unit shall be protected with a shroud fabricated of material conforming to PPP-B-1055, class L-2 (b). The exterior container design shall include three skids, each not less than 1-1/2 inches thick, applied crosswise of the base. They shall be so positioned as to facilitate handling with a forklift truck and to maintain unit in an upright position. Closure shall comply with appendix of applicable specification. Strapping will not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage.

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5.2.2 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packaged and packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each container shall be marked to identify contents.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard 129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Sterilization of Instruments and dressings in Field Hospitals.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Review activities:
Army - MD
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Air Force - 03

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6.4 This specification covers the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

FSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6530-926-2151	STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT AND DRESSING, Pressure, Steam, Electric, or Gasoline Burner Heated, Corrosion-Resisting Metal, 16 by 36 inches, 220 Volt, 50/60 Cycle, AC.

6.5 Spore strips in conformance with the requirements of 3.4.2 are commercially available as American Sterilizer Co. Spordi and Castle Co. Unispore and are stock listed under FSN 6530-477-6720, Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

6.6 The sterile fluid storage bottles referenced in 4.4.8.5.1 are stock listed under FSN 6530-935-4136 and are commercially available from the American Sterilizer Company as their catalog number SP-1000.

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document (s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

MIL-S-36567A FSN:

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE | CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)* | DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64, WHICH MAY BE USED.

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